

Project **Stable-Bridge**

USDC Remittance Feasibility Study

TEAM

The Emerging Markets Analyst Team

ASSET

USDC (Ethereum Mainnet) - Last 180 Days

PERSONA

Int'l Development Org / Remittance Company

MISSION

Investigate stablecoins for reducing remittance costs

Executive Summary

1. Whale Dominance

Transaction volume is heavily skewed toward ">\$10k" transfers. Retail-sized transfers (<\$500) make up a negligible fraction of daily volume.

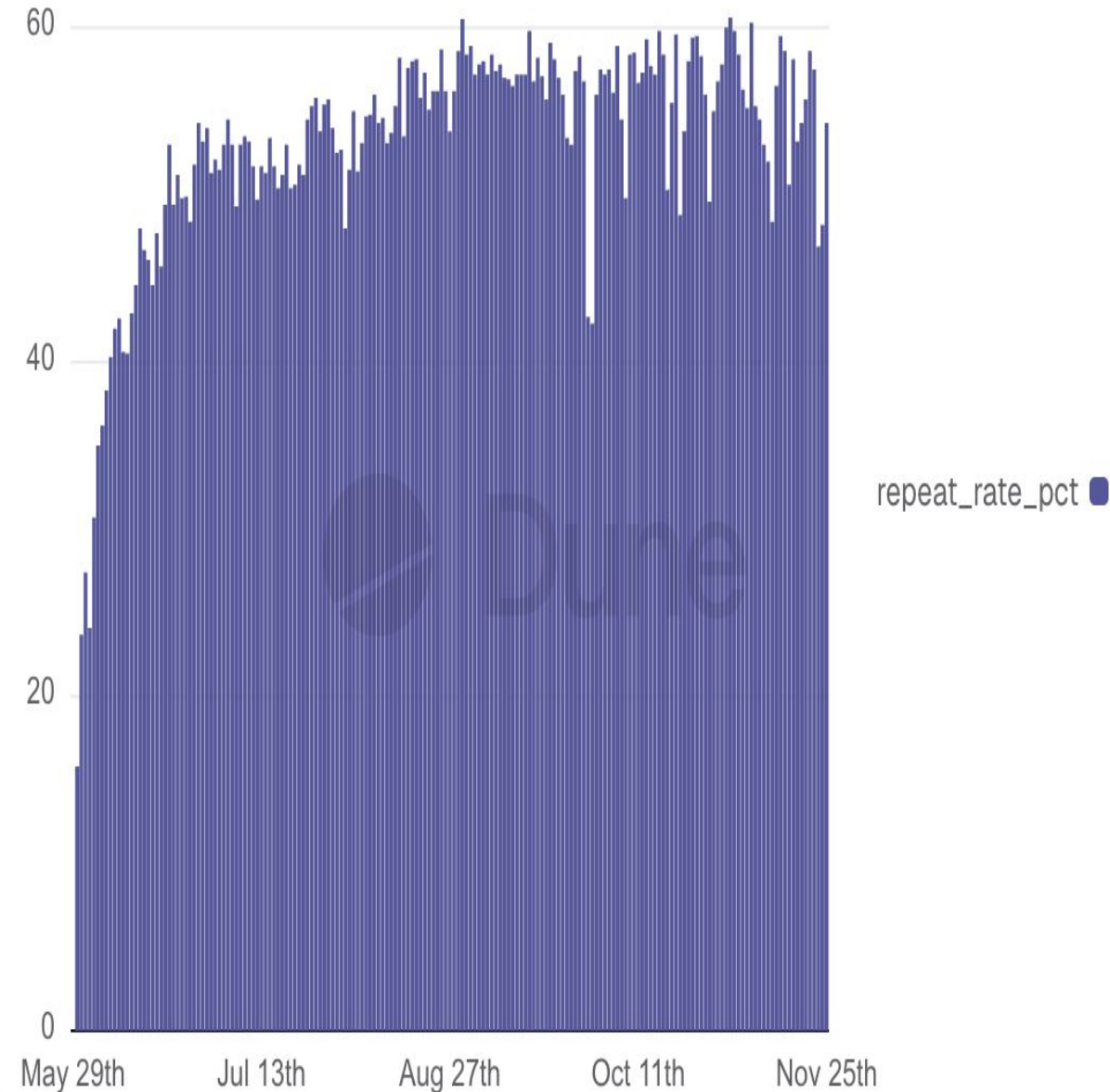
2. High Retention

User retention is ~55%, indicating that those who can afford gas fees are "power users," not one-off retail senders.

3. Strategic Recommendation

Do not launch on Mainnet. Pivot the pilot to Layer 2 (Base or Optimism) where fees are <\$0.10.

q5



Methodology

Data Source

On-chain data from **Ethereum Mainnet (ERC-20)** via Dune Analytics.

Contract Analyzed:

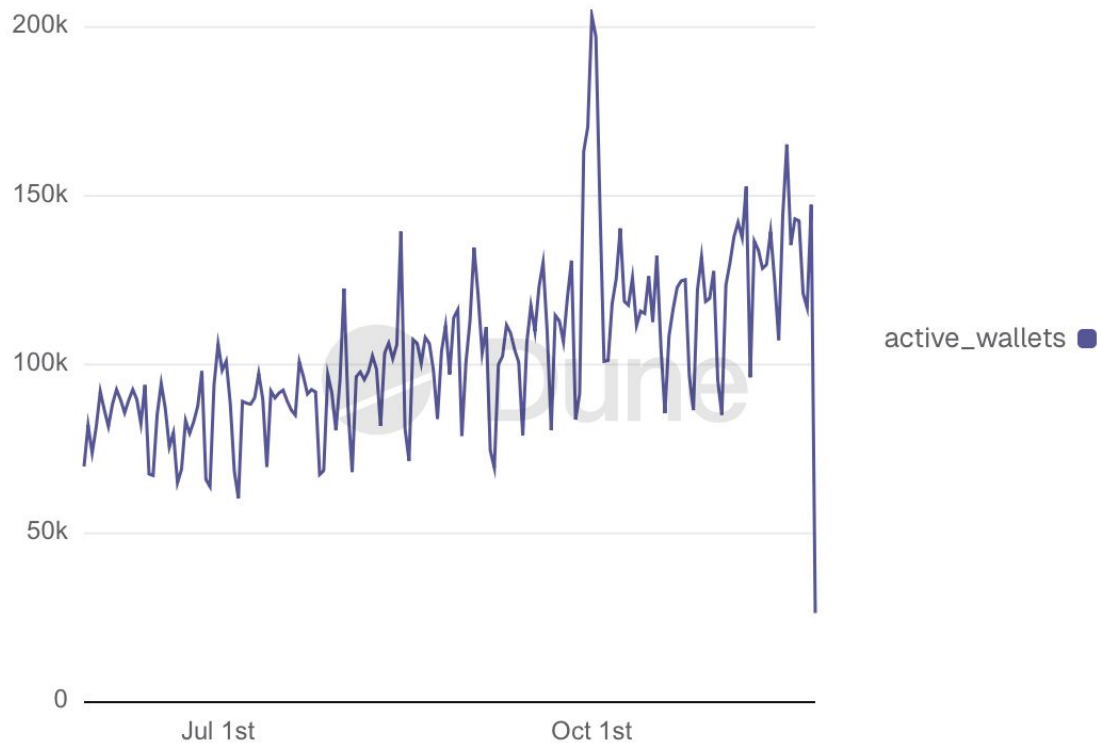
`0xa0b8...eb48` (USDC)

Scope & Limitations

- **Time Window:** Last 180 Days (Approx. June 2025 – Nov 2025).
- **Focus:** Sender/Receiver behavior, transfer value buckets, and retention rates.
- **Limitation:** This analysis only covers *on-chain* movements. It does not track internal ledger transfers within centralized exchanges (like Coinbase or Binance).

Deep Dive: Daily Active Wallets

Daily Active Wallets (Distinct Senders + Receivers) Q2



@bhavisharamnani_team_9791

14h

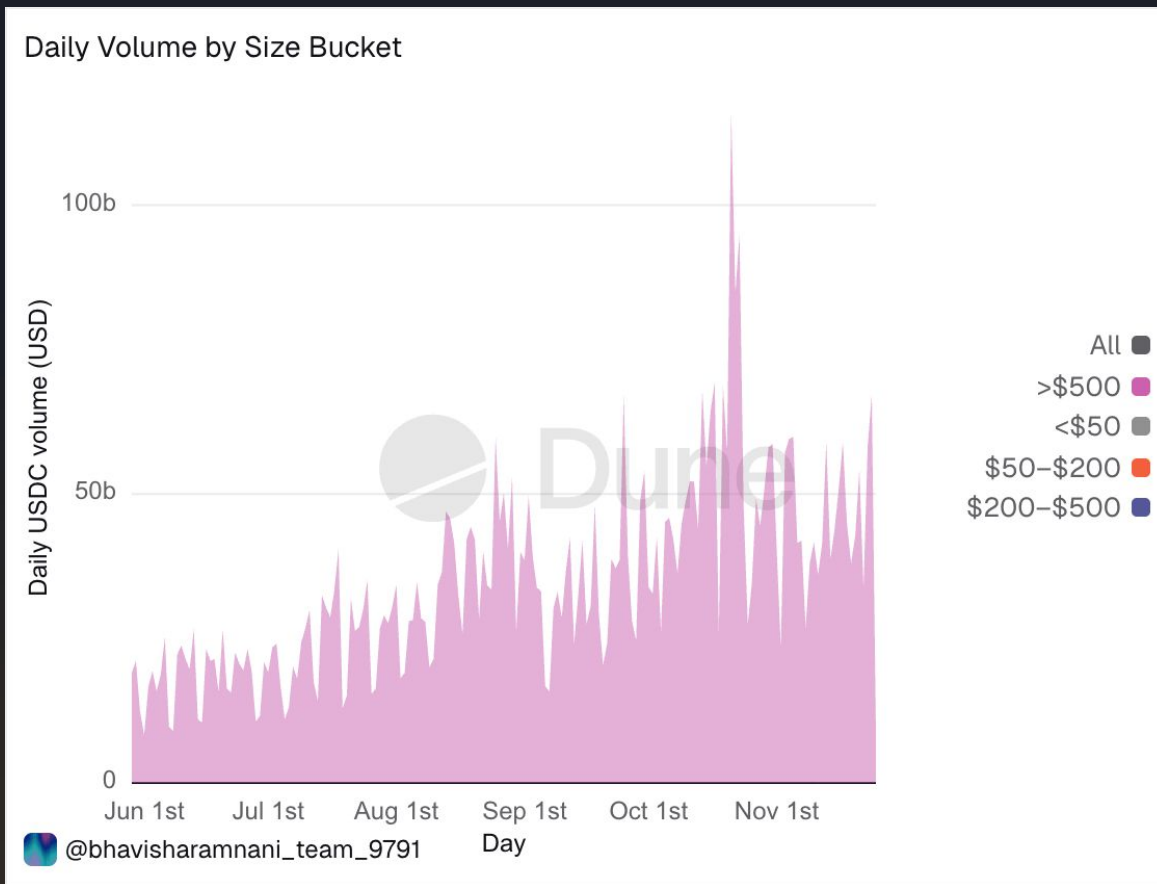
General Trend

We see a volatile but generally upward trend in daily active distinct wallets, peaking around October.

Interpretation

Sharp spikes suggest activity is driven by market events (trading opportunities) rather than consistent daily payments like wages.

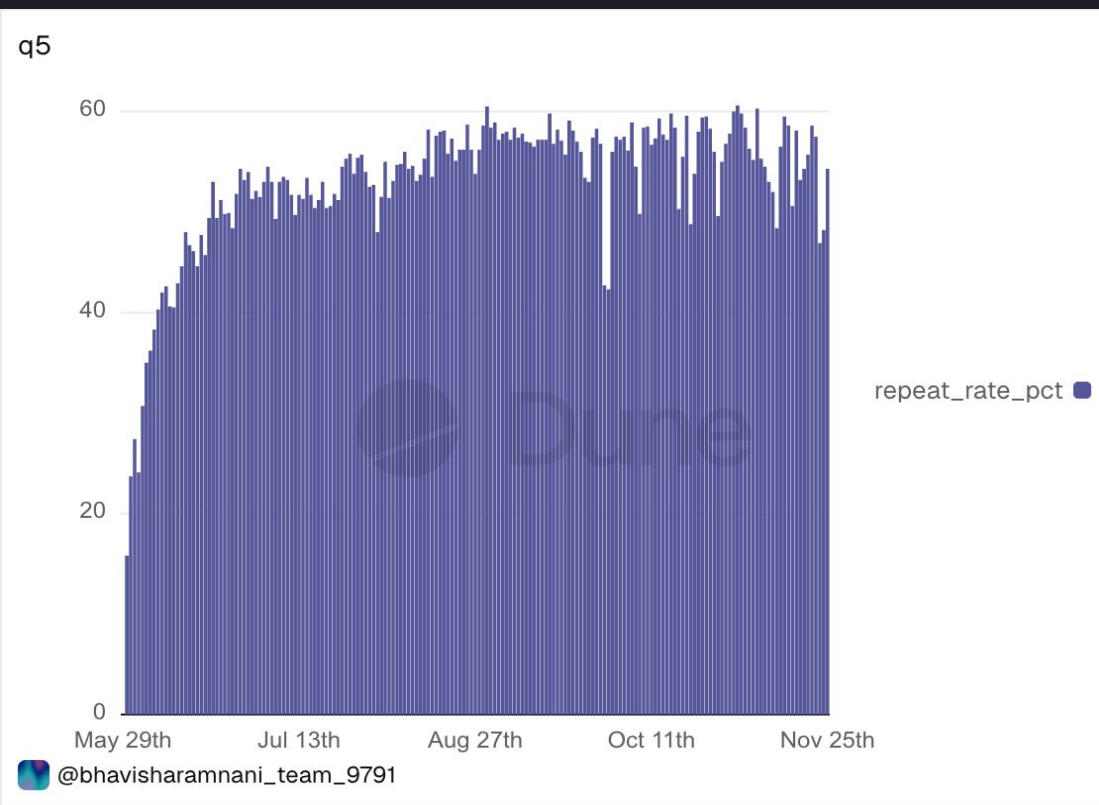
Deep Dive: The Retail Gap



Whale Dominance

- **The "Retail Gap":** The bands representing <\$200 transfers (typical remittance size) are barely visible compared to the institutional volume.
- **Mainnet Reality:** Mainnet is currently a settlement layer for the wealthy or protocols, not a payment rail for the average worker.
- **Fees:** Gas fees of \$2-\$10 make small transfers economically irrational.

Deep Dive: User Retention



Sticky User Base

- **Metric:** Percentage of wallets active today that have transacted before.
- **Insight:** The rate hovers around **55%**, which is very
- healthy.

Conclusion: We aren't seeing a flood of *new* retail users. The existing user base is "sticky" and returns frequently—classic power user behavior.

Conclusion & Next Steps



Immediate Action

Commission a comparative study on **Base** and **Solana** to compare transaction fees vs. USDC liquidity depth.



Product Implication

If we stay on Mainnet, we must target **B2B cross-border settlements (>\$10k)** rather than P2P retail remittances.



Further Analysis

Filter for "Human vs. Bot" activity to remove arbitrage bots and analyze "Time of Day" patterns for geographic insights.

SQL Appendix: Daily Active Wallets

```
-- Business Question: Track daily active wallets
WITH const AS (
  SELECT
    0xa0b8...eb48 AS usdc,
    current_timestamp - INTERVAL '180' day AS since
),
u AS (
  SELECT date_trunc('day', evt_block_time) AS day, "from" AS addr
  FROM erc20_ethereum.evt_transfer
  WHERE contract_address = (SELECT usdc FROM const)
  AND evt_block_time >= (SELECT since FROM const)
  UNION ALL
  SELECT date_trunc('day', evt_block_time) AS day, "to" AS addr
  FROM erc20_ethereum.evt_transfer
  WHERE contract_address = (SELECT usdc FROM const)
  AND evt_block_time >= (SELECT since FROM const)
)
```

Query Logic

This query combines both from (senders) and to (receivers) addresses from the evt_transfer table.

It deduplicates addresses daily using COUNT(DISTINCT addr) to get a true count of unique participants in the network.

SQL Appendix: Transfer Size Buckets

```
-- Categorize transfer volumes
WITH const AS (...)
SELECT
  CASE
    WHEN value/1e6 < 100 THEN 'Small < $100'
    WHEN value/1e6 < 1000 THEN 'Medium $100-$1k'
    WHEN value/1e6 < 10000 THEN 'Large $1k-$10k'
    ELSE 'Very Large ≥ $10k'
  END AS bucket,
  COUNT(*) AS tx_count
FROM erc20_ethereum.evt_transfer
WHERE contract_address = (SELECT usdc FROM const)
GROUP BY 1
ORDER BY ...
```

Query Logic

The CASE statement buckets transactions by value. Note that USDC has 6 decimals, so we divide by 1e6 to get the dollar amount.

This segmentation allows us to prove the dominance of institutional volume over retail volume.

SQL Appendix: Retention

```
-- Analyze retention by comparing new vs returning
WITH tag AS (
  SELECT
    day,
    addr,
    date_trunc('day', MIN(evt_block_time)
      OVER (PARTITION BY addr)) AS first_day
  FROM u
)
SELECT
  day,
  COUNT(DISTINCT addr) AS active_wallets,
  COUNT(DISTINCT CASE WHEN day = first_day
    THEN addr END) AS new_wallets,
  100.0 * ... AS pct_new
FROM tag
GROUP BY 1 ORDER BY 1;
```

Query Logic

This advanced query uses a WINDOW FUNCTION to find the first_day an address was ever seen in the dataset.

If current_day == first_day, they are a New User.

Otherwise, they are Returning.

Questions?

Thank you for your attention.

Data Source: Dune Analytics